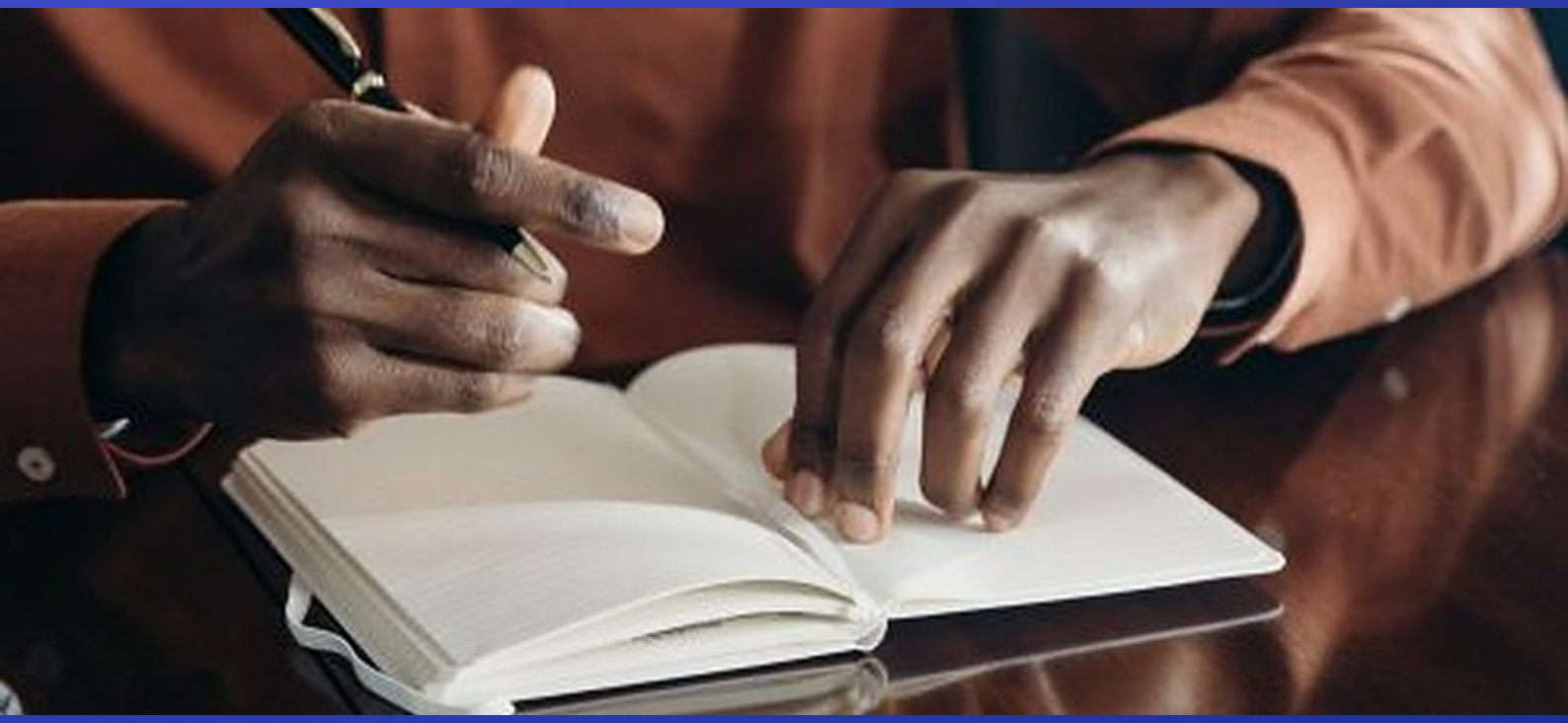
CHRISCO Youth Aflame
CHRISCO DIGITAL ACADEMY | CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

Ghostwriting Course Handbook

"Get paid well to write, while someone else takes the credit."

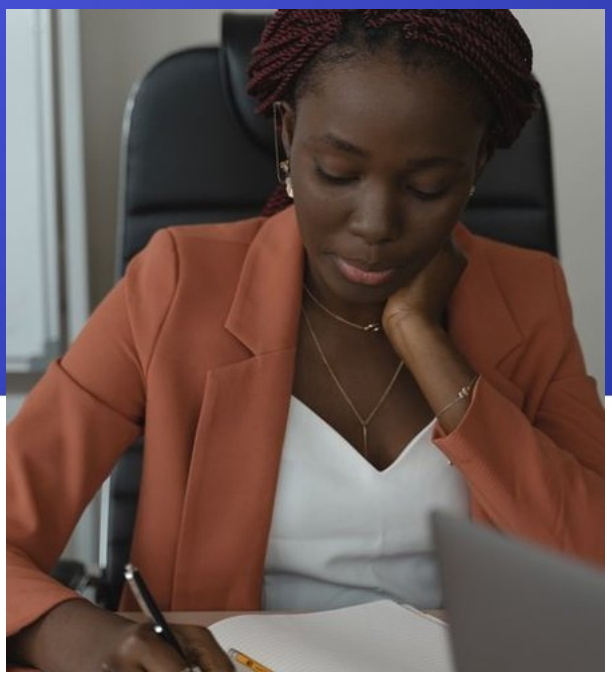


Editorial Writing & Publishing Track | 8 Weeks | All Levels

Self-Paced Study Edition

Prepared by CHRISCO Youth Aflame | chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com

Course Foreword



Busy people, founders, executives, influencers, have ideas and audiences but no time to write. They pay ghostwriters to turn their thoughts into polished content published under their name. If you can write clearly, this is one of the fastest ways to earn real money online with your words.

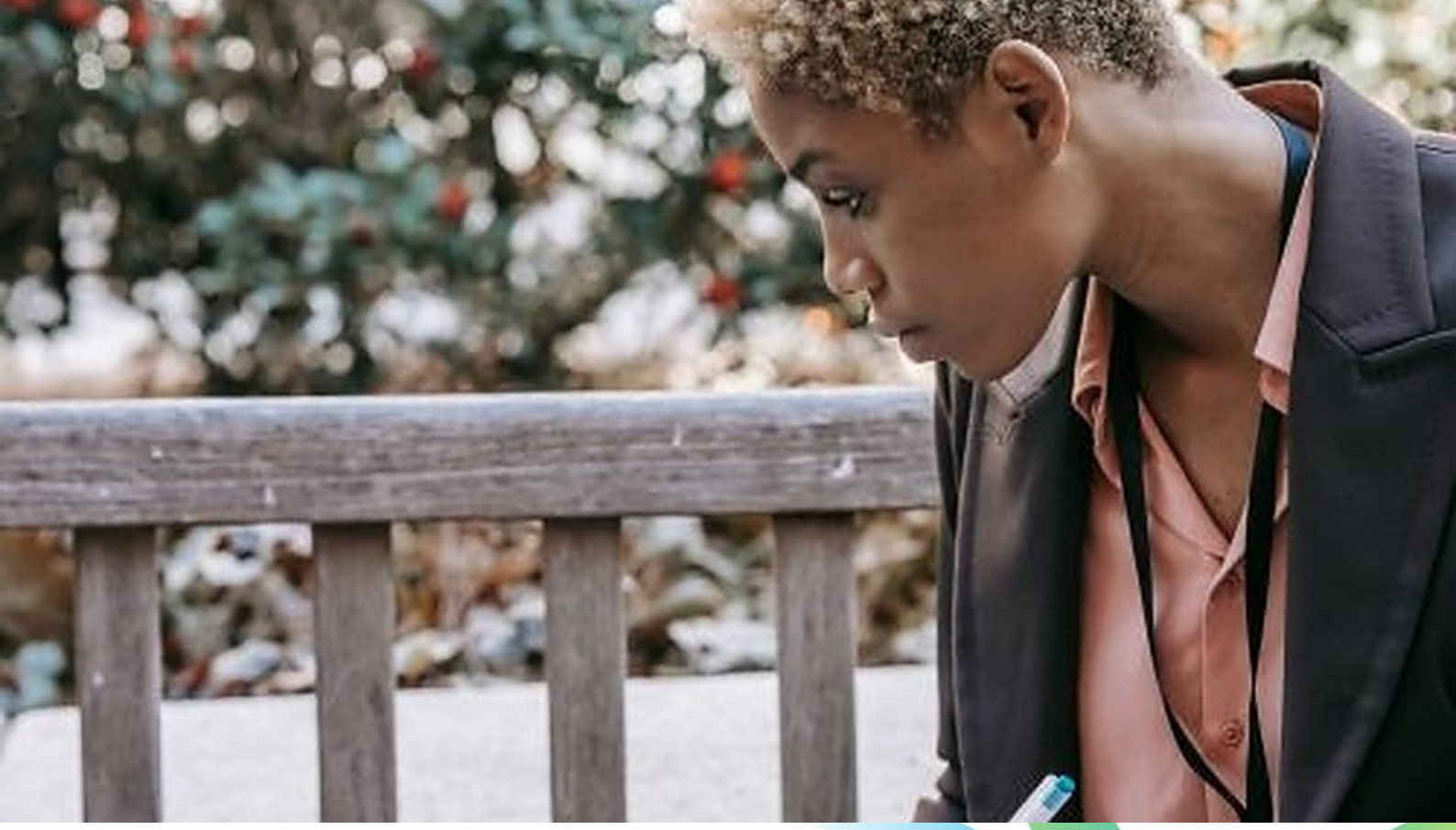
Ghostwriting is invisible by design: you do the work, they get the credit, and you get paid, often very well. The trade is fair, because your name lives in your bank balance and your private portfolio, not the byline.

THE PRACTITIONER PROMISE

You will learn to find clients, capture anyone's voice, write blogs, social posts and scripts, price your work properly, and build a portfolio that lands paid gigs.

You do not need to be a literary genius. You need to write clearly, meet deadlines, and sound like your client. This book shows you how, and pushes you to build the portfolio that gets you hired.

Published by CHRISCO Digital Academy under CHRISCO Youth Aflame (*CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches*), this 8-module workbook equips youth and emerging leaders with practical, ethical, income-ready skills. Complete every chapter drill in a dedicated workbook and reach our mentorship desk anytime at chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com.



Key Outcomes

01

What is ghostwriting: Ghostwriters write under the client's name.

02

Writing in someone else's voice: Write as the client, not as yourself.

03

Social media ghostwriting: Short-form ghostwriting is easy to start and in demand.

04

Pricing and contracts: Build a portfolio even before your first client.

Across 8 Weeks of structured practice, learners progress from core principles to real-world execution. Every module pairs concise frameworks with an immediate hands-on drill so knowledge turns into demonstrable competence.

Graduates finish with a tangible portfolio deliverable in Ghostwriting, ready to serve clients, employers, ministries, and communities with excellence and integrity.

Table of Contents

Course Foreword & Key Outcomes 02

01 Foundations & Core Mindset 05

02 Core Frameworks & Strategy 07

03 Execution & Applied Mastery 10

04 Scaling, Capstone & Excellence 12

05 8-Module Syllabus & Drill Matrix 14

06 90-Day Action Plan & Stewardship 15



01
Foundations & Core Mindset

Module 1: What is ghostwriting | Module 2: Finding ghostwriting clients



1.1 What is ghostwriting

A ghostwriter writes content that is published under someone else's name, blog posts, LinkedIn updates, newsletters, books, speeches, video scripts. The client provides ideas, expertise or a rough voice note; you turn it into finished writing in their voice. You stay invisible, and that invisibility is exactly what clients pay a premium for.

The work is in demand because good writing takes time and skill that busy, successful people lack. Content is how they build authority and attract customers, so they happily pay someone reliable to produce it. Understanding that you are selling time, clarity and consistency, not just words, helps you value the work correctly.

Real-World Example: Many popular LinkedIn thought-leaders and busy CEOs do not write their own posts. A ghostwriter takes a 5-minute voice note of their ideas and turns it into a polished post, and earns a healthy monthly fee for doing it a few times a week.

Hands-On Practice: Find three pieces of content online (a blog, a LinkedIn post, a newsletter). For each, imagine you were hired to write it, what ideas would the client have given you?

Core Takeaways: Ghostwriters write under the client's name. • Clients pay a premium for invisibility and reliability. • You sell clarity and consistency, not just words.

1.2 Finding ghostwriting clients

Clients are everywhere content is needed: startup founders, coaches, consultants, agencies and influencers. Find them on LinkedIn, freelance platforms, and by watching who posts inconsistently or writes poorly but has something to say, they are your ideal prospects. Reach out with a specific, helpful message, not a generic 'I write content' blast.

The best long-term clients come from proof and referrals. Start by writing sample pieces (even for imaginary clients) to show your range, offer a small first project to build trust, and always ask happy clients for referrals. Ghostwriting is a relationship business, one good client who keeps you on retainer beats ten one-off gigs.

01

Practitioner Case

A beginner messaged ten founders whose LinkedIn pages were quiet, offering to write three posts as a paid trial. Two said yes; one became a monthly retainer client. Specific, targeted outreach beat waiting to be discovered.

02

Action Drill

Identify five people online who clearly need writing help. Draft a short, specific outreach message offering to help one of them.

03

Key Standard

Target people who need content but lack time. Personal, specific outreach beats generic blasts. Retainers and referrals build a stable income.



02
Core Frameworks & Strategy

Module 3: Writing in someone else's voice | Module 4: Blog and article ghostwriting

2.1 Writing in someone else's voice

The core ghostwriting skill is sounding like your client, not like you. Before writing, study how they speak and write: their common phrases, tone (formal or casual), sentence length, and the stories they tell. Collect samples, listen to their voice notes or interviews, and build a mental (or written) profile of their voice.

Then write as them, not as yourself, resist inserting your own style. Read your draft aloud and ask, 'Would they actually say this?' The goal is that even their close colleagues cannot tell someone else wrote it. Nailing a client's voice is what turns a one-off writer into a trusted, well-paid long-term partner.

Core Principle

Write as the client, not as yourself.

Field Case Study

A ghostwriter kept a one-page 'voice sheet' for each client, favourite words, tone, do's and don'ts. Clients regularly said 'this sounds exactly like me', which is the highest praise a ghostwriter can earn, and what kept them paying.

Applied Exercise

Pick a public figure with a distinct style. Study three of their posts, then write a new post in their voice so convincingly it could pass as theirs.

Mastery Check

Study their words, tone and stories first. · Nailing their voice earns long-term trust.

2.2 Three-Step Execution Rhythm

Step 1	Prepare & Frame Write as the client, not as yourself.	Practice Focus Audit your current approach before acting.
Step 2	Execute Deliberately Study their words, tone and stories first.	Practice Focus Focus on clarity, calm pace, and measurable value.
Step 3	Review & Refine Nailing their voice earns long-term trust.	Practice Focus Record outcomes and sharpen one habit per rep.

2.3 Blog and article ghostwriting

Blogs and articles are bread-and-butter ghostwriting work. A good article has a clear purpose, a strong headline, a hook that pulls the reader in, well-organised points with subheadings, and a satisfying close. Even when writing in a client's voice, you bring the structure and clarity that keeps readers reading to the end.

Research matters: you often write about topics you are not an expert in, so you must quickly gather accurate information and present it clearly (verifying facts, especially if using AI to help). Deliver clean, well-structured, error-free drafts on time, and clients will keep coming back, reliability is as valued as talent.

01

Bring structure and clarity to every article.

02

Research and verify what you write.

03

Clean drafts on time win repeat work.

2.4 Real-World Case & Lab Assignment

Practitioner Case Study

A client gave a ghostwriter bullet points and a voice note. She turned them into a clear, well-structured 800-word article with a strong headline and subheadings. The client published it unchanged, and hired her for three more.

Your Practical Assignment

Take a topic you know a little about. Write an 800-word article with a strong headline, a hook, subheadings and a clear conclusion.

CHRISCO Youth Aflame Study Principle: "Bring structure and clarity to every article. Consistent execution in small daily assignments builds authority that cannot be faked."



03
Execution & Applied Mastery

Module 5: Social media ghostwriting | Module 6: Scriptwriting for YouTube

3.1 Social media ghostwriting

Short-form ghostwriting, especially LinkedIn and X posts, is booming and often the easiest to start with. The skill is packing a clear idea or story into a scroll-stopping few lines: a strong first line (the hook), a valuable or relatable middle, and a point or call to engagement at the end. Every word must earn its place.

Consistency is the client's real need, so many social ghostwriting gigs are retainers, a set number of posts per week. Learn each platform's style (LinkedIn rewards insight and stories; X rewards punchy takes), keep a bank of the client's ideas to draw from, and schedule ahead. Reliable, on-brand posts week after week are worth a steady monthly fee.



Case: A ghostwriter charges a monthly retainer to write eight LinkedIn posts for a consultant from his voice notes. It takes her a few hours a week, the client's following grows, and both are happy, the model that makes social ghostwriting so profitable.

Action Drill: Write three LinkedIn-style posts (hook, value, engagement prompt) for a client persona, each under 150 words and each with a scroll-stopping first line.

3.2 Scriptwriting for YouTube

Video creators need scripts, and many hire ghostwriters. A video script is different from an article: it is written for the ear and the eye, with a powerful hook in the first 15 seconds, a conversational tone, clear visual cues, and a pace that never lets the viewer drift. You write words meant to be spoken and watched, not read silently.

Structure the script to hold retention: open with the payoff, deliver value in tight sections, and guide toward the video's goal (subscribe, click, buy). Write in the creator's speaking voice and mark where visuals or emphasis go. Good script ghostwriters are valuable because a strong script is most of a video's success, and creators know it.



Case: A faceless-channel owner outsources scripts to a ghostwriter who nails the hook and pacing. The channel's watch-time rose after switching to her scripts, so she now writes several a week, well-paid, invisible work behind a growing channel.

Action Drill: Write a 2-3 minute YouTube script on a topic of your choice: a 15-second hook, clear spoken-style sections, and a closing call to action.



04
Scaling, Capstone & Excellence

Module 7: Pricing and contracts | Module 8: Build your full portfolio

4.1 Pricing and contracts

Beginners undercharge out of fear; do not. Price by the value and time involved, and move toward per-project or monthly retainer pricing rather than tiny per-word rates. As you build proof, raise your rates. Clients often respect a confident, fair price more than a suspiciously cheap one, low prices can signal low quality.

Protect yourself with clear agreements, even simple ones: scope (what and how much), price, deadlines, number of revisions, and payment terms (ask for a deposit upfront). Put it in writing before you start. Clear terms prevent the two biggest ghostwriting headaches, endless free revisions and clients who vanish before paying.

Field Example: A ghostwriter switched from charging per word to a monthly retainer with a set number of posts, a two-revision limit and a 50% deposit. Her income became predictable and disputes disappeared, all from a one-page written agreement. | Drill: Write your simple service agreement template: scope, price, deadline, revision limit and payment terms. Use it on your next client.

4.2 Build your full portfolio (Capstone)

Your portfolio is what gets you hired, and you can build it before you have a single client by writing sample pieces: a blog post, a set of social posts, a video script, maybe a newsletter, each showing you can capture a voice and deliver clean work. Put your best pieces somewhere easy to share (a simple document or site).

Because ghostwriting is confidential, use samples, anonymised work (with permission), or self-made pieces rather than naming clients. Aim for range and quality over quantity, a handful of excellent, varied samples proves more than a pile of mediocre ones. With a strong portfolio and confident outreach, paid work follows.

Competency Area	Capstone Standard	Starting	Target Mastery
1. Clarity & Preparation	Price on value; prefer projects and retainers.	Needs Draft	Confident & Ready
2. Execution Quality	Build a portfolio even before your first client.	In Practice	Portfolio-Grade
3. Real-World Proof	Create a portfolio of at least four varied writing samples (article, social posts, script, newsletter). Put them in one shareable document or page.	Planned	Completed & Reviewed
4. Consistency Habit	Quality and variety beat quantity.	Occasional	Weekly Discipline

5.1 Complete 8-Module Practice Matrix

Use this checklist to track every hands-on assignment in Ghostwriting from Module 1 to your final project:

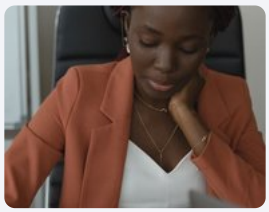
Module	Focus Topic	Core Deliverable & Principle
Module 01	What is ghostwriting	Ghostwriters write under the client's name.
Module 02	Finding ghostwriting clients	Target people who need content but lack time.
Module 03	Writing in someone else's voice	Write as the client, not as yourself.
Module 04	Blog and article ghostwriting	Bring structure and clarity to every article.
Module 05	Social media ghostwriting	Short-form ghostwriting is easy to start and in demand.
Module 06	Scriptwriting for YouTube	Scripts are written for the ear and eye.
Module 07	Pricing and contracts	Price on value; prefer projects and retainers.
Module 08	Build your full portfolio	Build a portfolio even before your first client.

5.2 Applied Fellowship Reflections

"Many popular LinkedIn thought-leaders and busy CEOs do not write their own posts. A ghostwriter takes a 5-minute voice note of their ideas and turns it into a polished post, and earns a healthy monthly fee for doing it a few times a week."

CHRISCO Youth Aflame Cohort Case Note | Module 01





"A newcomer with zero clients wrote five polished samples across blogs, LinkedIn and a script. That portfolio alone convinced a founder to hire her, proof, not experience, opened the door, and the experience followed."

CHRISCO Digital Academy Capstone Highlight | Module 08

06 90-Day Action Roadmap

True mastery in Ghostwriting is measured by what you build, ship, and steward after finishing the lessons. Follow this structured 90-day implementation plan developed by CHRISCO Youth Aflame (under CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches) to turn study into fruitfulness.

6.1 Four-Stage Post-Course Milestones

01

Days 1 to 14: Foundation Sprint

Complete Modules 1 to 4 drills and document your baseline specimen in Ghostwriting.

02

Days 15 to 30: First Live Output

Complete Modules 5 to 8 and ship your first real capstone deliverable: Create a portfolio of at least four varied writing samples (article, social posts, script, newsletter). Put them in one shareable document or page.

03

Days 31 to 60: Feedback & Iteration

Share your work with a mentor, peer, or real client/community audience and refine weak points.

04

Days 61 to 90: Service & Multiplication

Use your skill to serve your church, business, or clients faithfully and mentor one younger learner.

Follow-Up Stage	CHRISCO Support Channel	Contact & Cadence
Workbook Review	CHRISCO Digital Academy Desk	chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com
Capstone Submission	CHRISCO Youth Aflame Mentors	shambetz@gmail.com
Peer Accountability	CHRISCO Fellowship Study Hubs	Monthly Cohort Check-In

CHRISCO Youth Aflame
CHRISCO DIGITAL ACADEMY | CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

Equipping Youth, Elevating Purpose

CHRISCO Youth Aflame
CHRISCO Digital Academy
Under CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

Official Gmail Contacts
chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com
shambetz@gmail.com

Official Course E-Book for Ghostwriting (Editorial Writing & Publishing Track).
Prepared by CHRISCO Youth Aflame under CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES.
For course guidance or mentorship, email chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com.